

SIMPLIFYING TAXATION (From left) Ankit Solanki, Archit Gupta and Srivatsan Chari

THE NEXT 100 ENTREPRENEURS

The Tax Help Cometh

ARCHIT GUPTA, 36
ANKIT SOLANKI, 37
SRIVATSAN CHARI, 34

Co-founders, Clear (formerly ClearTax), **Bengaluru**

"India is on a massive digitisation journey and we are fortunate to be in the perfect storm of electronic invoicing, GST, UPI, cheap mobile internet and rapid adoption of technology due to Covid-19"

ARCHIT GUPTA

Archit Gupta returned to India in the summer of 2010 from San Francisco after the start-up he was working for, Data Domain Inc., was acquired by EMC Corporation. A conversation with his chartered accountant father at home regarding complexities in India's online tax-filing portal set Gupta thinking about his next move. He flew back to the US and researched on setting up a self-serving tax filing platform. ClearTax was launched just a fortnight before closure of the tax-filing window for FY2011 and quickly attracted 1,000-odd clients. In September 2011, at a hackathon he was hosting, Gupta met and teamed up with Ankit Solanki and Srivatsan Chari, both tech experts. The defining turn came in 2014 when ClearTax was accepted in the Silicon Valley-based Y Combinator start-up accelerator programme. In June 2021, ClearTax was rechristened Clear. It claims to have over six million Indians registered on its platform, including 50,000 tax experts; a million small businesses and 3,000 large enterprises. In October, it raised $75 million (Rs 560 crore) in Series C funding and is expected to use the money for expansion into the B2B credit and payments space and making Clear a complete financial services provider. ■

–Anilesh S. Mahajan

KYOTO CALLING Gupta wishes to travel to Kyoto to get a feel of its culture, food and nature. Ideally in the cherry blossom season, he says.